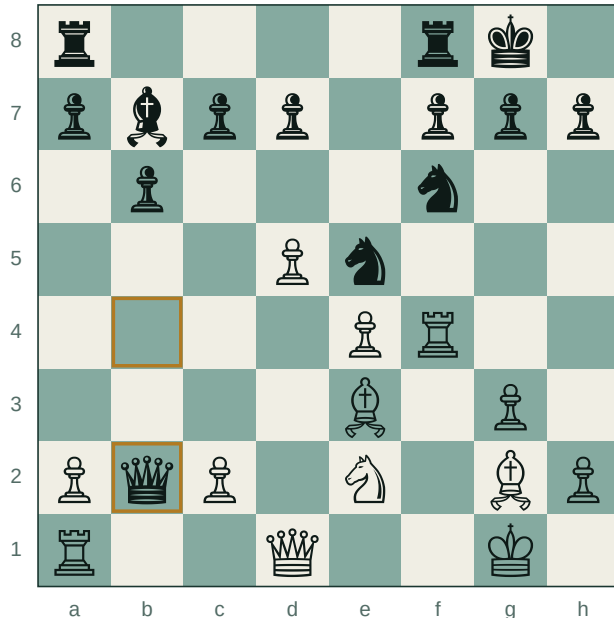


Interference tactics: White, move 14

Interference tactics

White to move



Previous move: 13...Qxb2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

14. Bd4 Qa3 15. Bxe5

14.Bd4 The bishop moves from e3 to d4. From d4 it attacks queen on b2 and knight on e5. Recorded reply: **14...Qa3**.

15.Bxe5 The bishop captures the knight on e5.

At the end, nominal material is White 34 / Black 32 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b7 and queen on b2. Check for tactical protection.